

Introduction to Web Development

WEDE5020: Proposal 2

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Group 2

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Organisation Overview

Name: Busisiwe Book Store

Brief History:

Busisiwe Book Store opened in 2021 with a simple mission: To provide a welcoming space where readers could discover new stories and connect with fellow book lovers. What began as a small shop selling new and used books has grown into a community hub that hosts readings, book clubs, and children story hours. The store is known for its carefully curated selection, personalised recommendations, and support of local authors.

Mission:

To nurture a love of reading by offering a carefully curated selection of books, fostering community through events, and providing a warm, inviting space for all readers.

Vision:

To become the heart of Pretoria's literary community, where every reader and author finds solace in the pages of books.

Target Audience:

- Local readers
- Parents and children
- Book clubs and educators
- Local authors

Product Categories

- Fiction
- Non-fiction
- Children and young adults
- Local interest
- Stationery and gifts

Services

- Online and In-store book sales
- Book club facilitation and discussion guides
- Author events and book signings

Website Goals and Objectives

Goals	Objectives	Key Performance Indicators
1) Increase book sales and inquiries	Create an online catalog that drives in store visits and online sales	• Monthly online orders or click and collect requests • In store sales attributed to website visits
2) Promote events and community engagement	Use the website to publicise book clubs, author readings, and children's events,	• Event page views • Online RSVPs • Attendance at events
3) Showcase the store's unique curated selection	Feature at least 50 new and recommended titles with staff picks, reviews and author notes.	• Number of book listings created • Customer engagement with curated content
4) Technical excellence and accessibility	Ensure that the website is fast, mobile friendly, and secure.	• Page load speed • High mobile friendly score

Current website analysis

Analysis of peer websites:

To inform the design and feature set, three established bookstore websites were examined: Van Schaik Bookstore, Exclusive Books, and Protea Boekhuis.

Van Schaik Bookstore employs a clear category navigation, prominent search functionality, and a mobile-friendly grid layout for product listings - all features planned for Busisiwe Book Store (Van Schaik, 2025). Its use of high-quality cover images, author details, and price information on product pages provides a model for effective presentation of book inventory.

Exclusive Books demonstrates the value of a loyalty programme, event listings, and a "Staff Picks" section that builds community and encourages repeat visits (Exclusive Books, 2025).

Protea Boekhuis showcases how an independent publisher and bookseller can integrate local authors, academic titles, and a blog to engage readers (Protea Boekhuis, 2020)

Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Core features

Feature	Description
Book catalog	A searchable list of books by category. Each book includes cover image, author, description, price, and "inquire" or "order" button
Event calendar	A list of upcoming events (author readings and book clubs) with dates and descriptions
Staff picks and recommendations	A curated section highlighting staff favorite books, new arrivals, and local authors
About and contact	Store story, location, hours, contact form, map, email, phone
Social media integration	Links to Busisiwe Book Store's Facebook, Instagram, and other platforms, placed in the footer for consistent visibility across all pages.
Responsive design	Full functionality across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices, ensuring accessibility for all users

Additional features

Feature	Description
Online store	• Full checkout with gateway for payment • Offer delivery options
Customer accounts	• Users can save addresses, view order history, and manage event bookings
Book club portal	• Reading lists, and a private forum for book club members
Newsletter archive	• Past newsletters with book recommendations and event recaps

Design and User Experience

The design needs to be inviting, and literary. Earthy tones, and a clean, purposeful typography selection will be used to create a comfortable reading atmosphere.

Colour Palette

Colour	Hex	Role
Lime green	#2C5F2D	• Head, footer, accents. To create a comforting mood to read
Cream	#FDF5E6	• Primary background. To draw consistent attention
Dark grey	#333333	• Body text. Contrasts with the background to enhance readability
Vivid Orange	#E67E22	• Calls to actions, buttons, highlights. Encourages interaction.

Typography

- **Headings:** Serif (Playfair Display)
- **Body text:** Sans serif (Lato)

Layout approach

- **Mobile first**
- **Engaging book catalog section**

- Simple navigation pattern with various categories

Low fidelity wireframes

A complete set of wireframes for the home page, book catalog, book detail, events, about, and contact pages has been created. They have been made to be in alignment with the basic structure and design choices outlined in this document. They are readily annexed as the attached document accompanying this proposal.

Technical requirements

- **Hosting:**
 - Cloud shared hosting
 - Storage
 - SSL
 - Backups
- **Domain:**
- **Technologies:**
 - HTML
 - CSS
 - Javascript
- **Security**
 - ReCAPTCHA on submission and contact forms
 - Data protection compliant with POPIA

Timeline and Milestones

Milestones	Target date
Project planning	24 March 2026
Research and content gathering	25 March 2026
Proposal Development	28 March 2026
HTML Structure and file organisation	31 March 2026
Final review	15 April 2026
Submission	20 April 2026

Budget

Item	Estimated cost
Domain registration	R109 - 250 (Yearly)
Web hosting	R100 - 140 (per month); Includes email

	hosting, SSL, required backups and storage
Contingency	R1000
Yearly costs	R2930

All costs exclude VAT

Costs are also assumed in house as outsourcing would incur additional costs

References

External sources drawn from inference into current local market as the client is fictional:

Various websites have been observed and analysed, influencing design decisions and structure.

Van Schaik.2025.Vanschaik Bookstore. [Online]. Available at :<https://www.vanschaik.com/> [Accessed 23 March 2026]

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W3C (World Wide Web Consortium). 2023. Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1. [Online]. Available at: <https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/>

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